



A MAN'S GUIDE TO

KNOWING HIMSELF

A SHORT HOW-TO MANUAL BY

TRUE NORTH

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A Quote

"True freedom is letting go of
the control you never had"

TRUE NORTH

The Intro

We (men) often experience a conflict within ourselves when we struggle to make sense of the emotional landscape of life. By emotional landscape I mean the true reason why we feel what we feel, and how to change it.

We may struggle to find a deeper connection with ourselves, believing that doing so means becoming too emotional or breaking down our safety barriers which will expose our vulnerability and make us "weak".

But a deeper understanding of oneself can be incredibly valuable. It can bring clarity to our decisions, enhance our relationships, and deepen our connection with the world around us. It can also be empowering, enabling us to make positive changes and improve our overall wellbeing.

In this short manual, I'll be sharing how you can find a deeper connection with yourself. We'll look at techniques and strategies to help you become more self-aware, which will reduce stress, and increase good resilience.

I'll also share tips on how to create a mindful environment and cultivate self-acceptance.

When doing 'the work' on ourselves, you quickly realise how many things are interlinked. So if it feels like some of the steps are repeating themselves, view this as an emphasis on the step and pay extra attention to it.

Note: I'm writing this short how-to manual from a place of understanding. I was the man who was all-in on the ego, fearful of showing any "weakness" and cared way too much about what others thought of me. Doing this work improved my life on all meaningful levels, and I hope it does the same for you.

Ready to get started?

ONE

Understanding Your Feelings

Our emotions can help us understand our innermost thoughts, beliefs, and desires. Us men in particular find it difficult to express our feelings openly and authentically, and often to avoid discussing many of our thoughts and needs.

But understanding and acknowledging our emotions is extremely important. Only when we understand and accept our emotions can identify patterns, adjust our behaviour, and make changes where necessary.

We can discover our true values and be better positioned to focus on the things that matter most.

ONE

UNDERSTANDING YOUR FEELINGS

So what can you do to help you understand your emotions a little better?

1. **Pay attention to how you feel and allow yourself enough time and space to observe and process these feelings.** Take a moment to identify the feeling. Identifying your emotions is the first and most important step to understanding them.

2. **Reflect.** Take a few moments to sit with your feelings and ask yourself ‘why?’. Once you’ve identified the feeling, dig a little deeper. Ask yourself why you are feeling that way— was it something that happened earlier in the day, a certain event or person, or something else?

3. **Talk to someone.** It’s important to share your feelings with someone you trust (not all feeling if you’re not ready) . But talking to someone can help you further process what you’re feeling and can be a great outlet for any frustrating or unwanted emotions.

ONE
UNDERSTANDING YOUR
FEELINGS

5. **Practice self-care.** Spend time doing activities that make you feel relaxed and calm, such as taking a walk, reading a book, or listening to music. Self-care is a great way to manage your emotions in a healthy, productive way.

6. **Learn from the experience.** Once you have identified, processed, and taken care of your emotions, it's important to look at the experience as an opportunity for growth. Reflect on the experience and think about what you can learn from it.

Remember don't be too quick to rationalise or dismiss them. Ask yourself questions, such as: What is causing the feeling? Why am I feeling this way about it? How can I approach the situation differently? How would I like to react?

This is what being in-tuned to your emotions looks like, give it a try, I promise it won't make you less of a man – in fact, this is the mature masculine in action.

TWO

Searching for Clarity

Often, when we're in search of clarity, we are looking to find a deeper connection with ourselves and our purpose.

without it, it can be difficult to know what the next step should be or if the decision you're making is the right one.

Gaining greater clarity starts with making an honest assessment of your current circumstances. Evaluate yourself, your goals and your values. Be mindful of how your decisions align with these. Consider how past experiences have informed your current behavior and pay attention to the messages you're sending to yourself.

Again, don't be afraid to ask for help or reach out for support. Spend time with friends and family, or talk to a trusted mentor. Get their opinion on your situation and let their perspectives help inform your decisions. You don't have to take it, you'll know if it feels right for you or not.

Take it from someone who spent many years searching for clarity alone... It can be a long and lonely road looking for answers in your own mind without another's perspective.

Instead of repeating my mistakes, try these:

1. **Expand your horizons:** Try taking a chance by exploring new activities or learning a new skill. This can help bring new perspectives and expose you to different ideas.
2. **Take time for self-reflection:** Set aside time each day or week for contemplation. Ask yourself questions about what you want and what paths your life might take.

3. **Develop a routine:** Consistent habits and routines can provide structure to your day and help you focus on what is important to you.

4. **Connect with your emotions and needs:** In order to find clarity, you need to understand what drives you and what needs you have. Take time to listen to your deeper self and become in tune with your emotions and needs.

5. **Get outside help:** I've mentioned this before and will do again. Help from others provide additional perspectives on difficult decisions.

6. **Make sure you have time for rest and relaxation:** Don't let stress or fatigue keep you from finding clarity. Make sure you set aside time for rest and relaxation so you can think more clearly.

THREE

Analysing Your Beliefs

Beliefs are something I often talk about on my Instagram page because what we believe is absolutely everything.

Our beliefs – the thoughts, values, and principles that dictate how we think and behave – can have a huge impact on how we interact with the world. After a bit of self-exploration (which is something else I encourage us to do more often) you will find that your beliefs are hindering you from progressing and keeping you stuck in unhelpful patterns.

Common limiting beliefs; I am not good enough. I don't have the necessary skills. I'm not worthy of success. I don't have the resources to succeed. I can't make a difference. I'm not confident enough. I'm too old. It's too hard to achieve my goals. I am not smart enough to make a change. I will always fail.

Start by identifying any negative or unhelpful beliefs you have. Reflect on where they may have come from, how they've likely informed your decision-making, and the impact it's having on your life.

It can also be helpful to question the validity of these beliefs. Do you have any evidence to suggest that this belief may not be completely true? Is it holding you back from reaching your potential? And, perhaps most importantly, can you replace it with something more helpful or empowering?

In my practice, I use something called the A-F model of limiting beliefs which is a great way to discover and overcome success-killing beliefs. [Join the True North WhatsApp and hit me up for the model](#) – But keep reading for some other ways to beat the non-serving beliefs.

FOUR

Letting Go of Limiting Beliefs

Now that you've gone through the process of analysing your beliefs, you'll likely have identified ones that are no longer serving you. It's important to let go of these limiting beliefs in order to make room for more empowering and affirming ones.

First, recognise that these beliefs are not serving you. It's okay to challenge them and test them out. Give yourself permission to walk a new path. I know this may sound a bit wishy washy to begin with, but give it a go.

Often, we hold onto beliefs due to fear. Understand that fear is natural and we can choose to follow our fear or choose to do something different.

FOUR

LETTING GO OF LIMITING BELIEFS

Here are a couple of simple-ish things you can do to break through these beliefs:

1. **Challenge the beliefs:** Once you have analysed the beliefs it is important to challenge them. Ask yourself questions such as “What evidence do I have to support this belief?” or “Is this a belief I really want to keep?”. This will help you to separate the good from the bad and start to create healthier and more positive beliefs.
2. **Create new beliefs:** Once you have identified, analysed, and challenged your old beliefs it is important to start creating new, healthier, and more positive beliefs. Begin by thinking about what kind of man you would like to become. What would you like to believe? Write down the new beliefs and keep them somewhere where you can refer back to them and remind yourself of them regularly.

FOUR
LETTING GO OF LIMITING
BELIEFS

Once you make the conscious decision to let go of the limiting belief, make sure that you forgive yourself for not doing this before and move forward.

We can get caught in the trap of beating ourselves up for not doing what we think we should've done earlier. Thing is, you weren't ready then. Now you are.

FIVE

Reframing Unhelpful Patterns

We all have patterns of thought and behaviors that are unhelpful and don't support us. These patterns can negatively impact us, holding us back from achieving our goals and experiencing true joy.

Take some time to explore the unhelpful patterns you've identified, and be honest with yourself. You're only delaying your growth if you try and cut a corner here.

Try to look at them from an outside perspective. Has anyone said you're a certain way but you disagree with? Ask yourself if there's any truth to them or if it's just your ego/fear talking.

FIVE
REFRAMING UNHELPFUL
PATTERNS

Think about how you can reframe the thoughts that cause the behavior in order to find a more helpful response. To give an example of what unhelpful thoughts and behaviors sound and look like is:

"What's the point of even trying? I'll probably fuck it up anyway.'

"I know I've got stuff on tomorrow, but I'll just go for one beer, I deserve it. It's been a long week.'

'I can't do it now, I have x, y, and z to sort out. Now just isn't the time.'

How do yours sound? Seek out new positive perspectives that can improve or change the pattern.

SIX

Reassessing Priorities

Ok so now you're nearly ready to start moving forward again. When stepping back to gain a newfound perspective, it can help to look at the bigger picture.

Think about the grand scheme of life and the dual focus of your goals. Look at all the small things that have been consuming time and mental capacity, and decide what you will no longer entertain.

Focus on both long-term goals and short-term objectives. Give priority to what will bring you success and happiness in both the short term and the long term. Consider how to develop sustainable practices that lead to lasting effects.

Remember not to make the mistake of trying the things you've already tried.

I remember when I first started building companies, all I thought of was website, website, website. I'd spend weeks, sometimes even months trying to build one. Why? Because it was fun, and I didn't mind doing it. What I wasn't doing was making money... although it gave me the feeling of putting the work in.

We tend to go back to the same time-wasting distractions to prevent us from doing what actually needs to be done. Aka, procrastination.

Beware that the mind will trick you into thinking you're doing something different, when in fact, , you're simply doing the same thing but slightly differently.

That being said, procrastination can be something a little deeper set into than the simple idea of wasting time.

If you find yourself unable to focus and do the needle-moving tasks. Stop and ask yourself some powerful questions.

But you must also remember, to make time for self-care amidst the chaos, and don't forget to enjoy the journey. Celebrate small victories as you move closer towards your goals.

We so often think we're not making progress when we have yet to see the tangibles materialise. So be sure to set and track milestones and appreciate your growth.

SEVEN

Being More Mindful

Mindfulness is a word that has been thrown around loads over the last few years. But what is it?

In my opinion, it's a powerful tool that can completely transform your life. This practice allows you to become more aware of what is happening in the present moment, without any judgment or attachment.

When engaging in mindful practices, focus on your breathing. Notice the present moment without resistance. Observe your thoughts without attaching to them. Take account of your emotions without judging them.

If you're thinking 'wtf'? how do I do that, read on:

This practice can open up a whole new world of insight and connection within. Practicing mindful awareness opens up new opportunities and helps to fuel personal growth.

Of course, I can't talk about Mindfulness without mentioning meditation. If you're not already meditating daily, then you've probably considered making it part of your day at some point.

Meditation changed my life, I see it as taking my mind to the gym, and building the mind-muscle.

Here are my steps to becoming more mindful:

1. **Engage in daily meditation:** Practicing a daily meditation practice helps to cultivate mindful awareness, and can be as short as 10 minutes a day.

2. **Be aware of your breath:** Mindfulness begins with being aware of the breath and body. Pay attention to how your breathing feels, notice the air moving in and out of your lungs.
 3. **Practice mindful movement:** Implement mindful movement practice such as yoga, or simple stretching exercises to become more present with the physical sensations of the body. (Not just banging out weights)
 4. **Cultivate curiosity:** Ask yourself curious questions and make an effort to be mindful in everyday activities such as showering, brushing your teeth, or cooking. Be truly present in these everyday activities.
 5. **Eat mindfully:** Mindfully eating encourages a deeper awareness of the sensation of eating and being aware of the smell, taste, and texture of the food being consumed.
 6. **Accept distractions:** Be mindful of distractions and don't try to push them away but rather acknowledge them and let them pass.
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7. **Spend time in nature:** Spend some time outdoors every day and challenge yourself to notice new details in the environment around you.

8. **Practice gratitude:** Make it a daily practice to write down at least three things that you're grateful for. Writing them down will help to make you more mindful of them.

9. **Notice feelings and emotions:** Notice what you're feeling name the emotion and observe it without judgment or getting lost in it.

10. **Develop a your practice:** Create a consistent practice of engaging in mindful activities on a regular basis to help anchor yourself in being mindful.

By now you'll notice that a few steps have been repeated. This is to emphasise the importance of these activities if finding the connection to your true inner-self is something you're interested in.

EIGHT

Choosing Gratitude

We all need to take a step back and recognise the positive in life. Choosing to be grateful and thankful is a powerful way to gain a new perspective.

Make a conscious effort to be appreciative and grateful, even in difficult times. Acknowledge and vocalise your appreciation for the small things as well as the larger accomplishments. Journaling your gratitude is a great way to stay connected to this practice.

It can be easy to get caught up in a negative cycle. Begin to bring more light and love into your life by consciously making an effort to celebrate the things you're grateful for.

1. **Start a gratitude journal:** Take time each day to write down things you are grateful for. It can help you keep perspective and become more mindful of the blessings in your life.
2. **Show appreciation:** When something good happens or you receive a kind gesture, take the time to express your gratitude. A simple thank you can go a long way.
3. **Do random acts of kindness:** Doing something nice for someone can make you feel good, and it can also inspire them to pay it forward. You may have heard this before, see this as a little nudge.
4. **Practice mindfulness:** Again, take time to be mindful and focus on the present moment. This WILL help you become more aware of the positive things in your life.

5. **Smile and look for the good:** Smiling can boost your mood and the mood of those around you. Looking for the positive in any situation can help you focus on the things to be thankful for.

6. **Acknowledge your mistakes:** Taking responsibility for your mistakes and acknowledging when you were wrong can help you be grateful for the opportunity to learn and grow.

I know it sounds like a lot, but this things become second nature and takes seconds. Don't get overwhelmed by the list.

Once you consistently start to implement gratitude into your life, you will feel an internal shift, an appreciation for life, and your glass will for sure always be 'half full'.

NINE

Creating A Mindful Environment

Creating an environment that's conducive to mindful practices can be beneficial in living a more fulfilling life. Take a look at the things that bring you peace and comfort.

Surround yourself with objects items, and people that bring you joy or serve as reminders of your personal values and goals. Connect with nature and get out into the sunshine. Spend time in environments that make you feel connected, nourished, and complete. Are the places you're spending time in giving you this?

Allow yourself to step away from gadgets and technology. Maximise your time in the moment and allow it to serve you better.

NINE
CREATING A
MINDFUL ENVIRONMENT

1. **Find balance:** Create a calm, comfortable atmosphere with a combination of elements that bring you joy.
2. **Invest in mindfulness tools:** Buy the books, listen to the podcasts (or me), and find the things that remind you to stay present. But use them.
3. **Create mindful habits:** Like we spoke about in chapter seven. Read inspiring books, try mindful walking, and practice yoga and meditation.
4. **Stay connected to nature:** Make sure you're spending time in an environment surrounded by natural beauty. Even if its a walk in the park. It really does work when done consciously.
5. **Get organised:** Declutter and organise your home and workspace to make it more functional and calming.

NINE
CREATING A
MINDFUL ENVIRONMENT

7. Incorporate scent: Consider diffusing essential oils, lighting scented candles, and burning incense to help you relax and stay mindful. A bit girly I know, but it really is nice. I like sandalwood and frankincense – a bit more masculine.

8. **Disconnect from screens:** Try to unplug from your screens and take a break from the digital world.

9. **Practice self-awareness:** Pay attention to your emotions and practices gratitude for all that you have.

TEN

Cultivating Acceptance

Men should cultivate acceptance for several reasons.

Acceptance will help us to be emotionally present and more mature, to better understand and empathise with others, to appreciate diversity, and to develop healthy relationships.

Acceptance can be difficult to practice in the heat of a moment. Take a step back and accept the situation as it is. Instead of denying the current moment, allow yourself to feel it and embrace it.

Being able to recognise and accept the areas in your life that need more work can be a great way to move forward. It's easier to transform an issue when you start from a place of acceptance rather than denial.

Acceptance can lead to growth and understanding at a deeper level. Doing this can truly move you closer towards the life you desire.

Here are some tips to help cultivate acceptance:

1. **Stay open-minded** – Take the time to listen and learn from others, even if you do not agree with them at first. Become aware of the discomfort in doing this.
2. **Respect differences** – Show respect for the views of others and look beyond the surface to better understand their perspectives.
3. **Value empathy** – Practice self-acceptance and make sure to appreciate the perspectives of others. We never know how they got there.
4. **Notice negative judgments** – Monitor your thoughts and try to catch yourself when you are making negative judgments about someone.

5. **Practice self-reflection** – Take the time to reflect on yourself and develop insight into why you have a certain opinions or attitudes.

6. **Forgive and move on** – Let go of hurt feelings, forgive those that have wronged you, and start fresh.

True growth is near impossible if you're unable to forgive or accept. Holding on to things that happened in the past is simply adding extra weight for us to carry into our future.

ELEVEN

Developing a Regular Practice

Any sort of meaningful transformation requires a commitment to practice. This regular practice is what helps solidify your goals and dreams in your daily life.

I feel that as men, it's crucial for us to develop personal development and even spiritual practices because they bring inner peace, clarity, strength, and calmness into life.

With consistent practice, these activities create personal growth and an openness to life's challenges and its ultimate joys.

ELEVEN
DEVELOPING A
REGULAR PRACTICE

Cultivating a daily practice can open you up to a whole new level of living and being. Be patient and consistent with yourself and watch the positive transformation unfold.

Here are a few steps on how to get started:

1. **Commit to regular practice.** This could involve anything from taking a few minutes in the morning to sit in meditation and reflect on the day ahead or committing to longer sessions at least once, twice a week, aiming for every day.
2. **Practice mindfulness.** We're here again. Mindful activities such as walking, yoga, and writing can help open up the door for deeper spiritual exploration as well as self-connection.

3. **Get creative.** This could involve intentionally finding creative outlets like writing, painting, music, and anything else that may help to find expression of our innermost thoughts and feelings.
4. **Setting daily goals or intentions.** Consider what would make each day a successful day for you.
5. **Develop a personal evaluation process.** Take a day or two to check in with yourself and evaluate how you are feeling mentally, physically, and spiritually and use this to inform our short and long-term goals. This was a game-changer for me.
6. **Seek out a coach/mentor or like-minded individuals who can offer advice and input, as well as support and accountability.**

TO WRAP THIS UP

Truly knowing yourself is a superpower and comes with all the mental clarity you need. Finding this mental clarity is a journey of self-discovery that requires time and effort. However, it's time and effort well spent.

Becoming mindful of your thoughts, emotions, and actions is what will propel you forward. It's what will bring you inner peace, joy, and purpose.

The more you practice self-awareness, the more you can break down the walls of limiting beliefs and open up to the life of abundance you deserve. Take it one step at a time, and keep growing with intention and confidence.

You have the ability to tap into your potential and create a life that is meaningful for you. Look within, take the steps mentioned in this manual, and trust in the process.

You already know who you are, you feel him... we just need to remove the blocks in the way preventing that amazing version of you from showing up each day.

Be mindful, stay present, and take each day as an opportunity to choose your best self.

So at this point, you might be asking... but HOW?

You may be thinking 'I've tried these things before but not been able to apply them'.

How can I truly connect with my truest-self, gain peace of mind, and create a life I truly want?'

If this sounds like you, and you're someone who's found value in this guide and is ready to take the next steps...

Here is where I recommend going next...

#1 - Join The True North Circle

Inside this community, you'll find others on the same journey as you — Those to elevate their lives on all levels.

[Click here to join Us.](#)

IN CONCLUSION

That's all I've got for now...

I hope you enjoyed this guide...

And I hope we can stay connected.

It's been an honour sharing some of the biggest lessons I've learnt with you.



All the best
TRUE NORTH